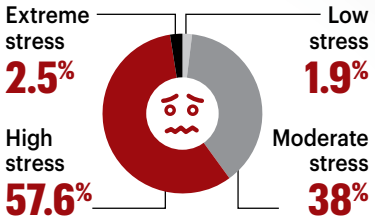
THE STRESS METER

Three out of five employees experience high or extreme stress levels, reveals a 2023 survey of 2,000 employees



Source: YourDOST

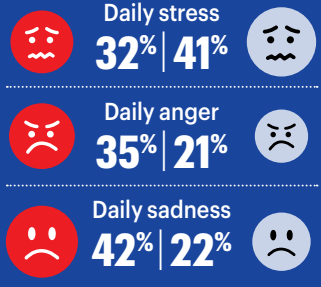


WHY THE INDIAN EMPLOYEE IS STRESSED

- **Long working hours, with expectations to work on weekends and holidays, heavy workloads**
- **24x7 connectivity, globalisation and the rise of the service economy, forcing people to work in shifts and across time zones**
- **Young executives are taking on senior roles with no training on people skills**
- **Technology is disrupting business models, and employees have to unlearn and upskill to stay relevant for next 2-3 decades**
- **Faster attrition rates are preventing relationship-building among colleagues**
- **The Smartphone Generation is prone to anxiety**

BURNOUT SIGNALS

Emotions that Indian employees feel "a lot" during their workday

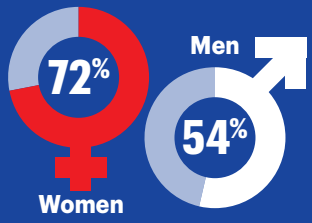


Source: Gallup

Young people are more stressed



Work-life imbalance places more burden on women



Source: YourDOST

has shortened the tenure of managers in firms. Teams have become transient, with several new people at any given time. "This leads to a lack of relationship-building and long-term thinking among managers," says Shankar. The problem is especially pronounced in hybrid working environments, where remote workers remain often unseen and unheard, and the work environment has not fully adapted to support mental health in this new set-up.

Reared on smartphones and social media, Gen Z and, to some extent millennials, are also more prone to anxiety, self-harm and related disorders than previous generations. This is what social psychologist Jonathan Haidt has concluded in his recent book *The Anxious Generation*. A 'phone-based childhood' instead of a 'play-

"The old notion that weekdays are for work and you can rest only on weekends is flawed. These elements of well-being can't be compartmentalised. Companies must create space within the weekday for employees to unwind"



- DR S.P. BYOTRA
Senior Consultant, Sir Ganga Ram Hospital